

prune. Leave the fruited canes of fall-fruiting varieties in the ground over winter. They should be cut right back in late winter–early spring. New canes will appear in spring. Do not prune container-grown raspberries.

HARVESTING

Raspberries will either be a summer- or fall-fruiting variety, and will be ready to harvest accordingly. When berries are plump and juicy, pull them off the plant, leaving the core attached to the bush. Eat them as soon as possible. Once stems have fruited, cut them off to ground level and cover with compost to help them decompose—this helps to prevent infection from entering the plant. If growth has been particularly good, you may need to thin out the remaining stems to leave one approximately every 4 in (10 cm). New plants can be propagated from healthy, disease-free suckers or new canes, which should be carefully removed from the rootball with their roots intact and then replanted.

STORING

Raspberries will not keep long after they ripen. Freeze them to prevent them from spoiling.

TIP TRAINING

There are two good reasons for training raspberries: first, it is important that they receive adequate space and ventilation and are not allowed to trail on the ground, where they become easy prey for pests and diseases. Second, it is much easier—and much less painful—to harvest berries from a well-trained plant.

There are many different ways to train your canes—insert one or two lines of posts and fix horizontal wires between them. Canes can be planted along the bottom of each line of posts and trained upward (known as the hedgerow system), or planted down the middle of a set of two, then drawn upward and diagonally out from the center (the Scandinavian system).



When raspberries reach full height, arch them over and tie in. Plants are kept neat, are less prone to damage, and fruits are easier to harvest.